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ECONOMIC STIMULUS

12 NOVEMBER 2020

INDIA | 4,85,019 ACTIVE CASES | 1,29,536 DEATHS

WORLD | 1,20,88,604 ACTIVE CASES | 13,90,276 DEATHS

A slew of new stimulus measures were announced by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman under the Atmanirbhar Bharat Package 3.0. Riding high on the success of the Garib Kalyan Rojgar Abhiyaan and increase in MNREGA uptake, the Atmanirbhar Bharat Rojgar Yojana was launched. This was intended to incentivize creation of new employment opportunities during the COVID-19-recovery phase in which the Union government would pay the employment provident fund contributions on behalf of the employees and employers for organizations employing up to 1,000 individuals. She also provided for an additional ₹10,000 crore for the PM Garib Kalyan Rojgar Yojana. The emergency credit line scheme which offered collateral-free loans to MSMEs and individuals for business purposes was extended until March 2021. In order to offer a significant boost to economic growth and domestic employment, the finance minister announced the approval of the Production Linked Incentive Scheme in 10 sectors in addition to the three sectors already approved earlier at the cost of ₹51,355 crore—critical key starting materials, drug intermediaries and active pharmaceutical ingredients and manufacturing of medical devices. In addition, another ₹18,000 crore was sanctioned under the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY) in order to revive the housing and real estate sector. The additional funds would help to ground about 12 lakh houses and complete the construction of about 18 lakh which would help create job opportunities to over 78 lakh individuals and increase steel consumption by